

60 Visual Routine Cards

Helps little ones see what comes next. Morning, meals, play, outside, reading, bath, bedtime, helping jobs and feelings.

60 picture cards

3 chart layouts

Play first / screens later

Fillable blanks

US Letter + A4

🕒 About 20 minutes to prep one routine, then reusable.



60 cards for the moments that matter most

Morning, meals, play, outside, reading, bath, bedtime, helping jobs, feelings, plan words and the **Play first / Screens later** pair. Screens get their own steady spot in the day, after play; it doesn't grow or shrink with jobs or behavior.

0-2 YEARS

Show one card right before it happens, or two on the first-then board, laid on top: "First shoes, then park."

2-3 YEARS

A strip of three or four cards for one routine. Your child moves each card to All done.

3-5 YEARS

The morning chart, up to nine steps. Let them choose the order of two steps.

Set up in 2 minutes

1. Pick one routine you already do.
2. Print its cards and one chart at 100% (Actual size).
3. Lay three cards on the chart and start tonight. Laminating can wait.

What your child is practising

Knowing what comes next, doing a real job in their own day, and words for everyday things and feelings. Nothing to get right.

Try this tonight: a four-card bedtime

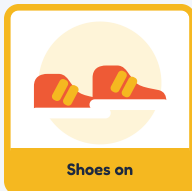


Want more?

The Complete Set has all 230 cards, including 58 big-kid cards for ages 5-12, 6 chart layouts, 4 colorways and Monday or Sunday starts.

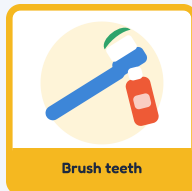
The cards are the start of a conversation

A routine card is something to talk about together, not a replacement for talking. Start with the first three ideas; add the others when you like. There's nothing to get right.



Say what you see

"Shoes on! Blue shoes." Name the card as your child touches it.



Pause and wait

"First teeth, then..." and wait a few seconds. A point, a look or a sound is an answer.



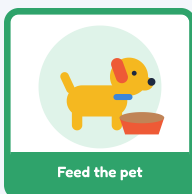
Repeat and add one word

Your child says "bath." You say "warm bath." One word more than they said.



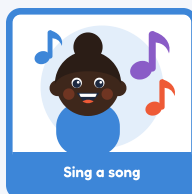
Offer a choice

Hold up two play cards: "Blocks or puzzle?" Let them pick and put it on the chart.



Follow their lead

If they grab the dog card, talk about the dog. The plan can wait ten seconds.



Sing and gesture

Make up a tidy-up tune or a wave for "all done." Same song, same moment, every day.

Every language counts

Talk, sing and read in the language you know best. Every language counts. Family words, home languages and pet names all belong on these cards. A sign, a point or a tap on a card counts as communicating too.

If interest fades

Put the cards away for a week, then bring back just two. Let your child choose which routine gets a chart, or hand them the job of moving the cards. Most children love 2–3 of these; that's normal.

What to print (and what to skip)

You don't need to print everything. Pick one colorway, print the cards for the routines you use, and add one chart.

GUIDE	PAGES
Grown-up guide, talk tips, print guide, laminating and safety	2–5
CARDS (60 + SECOND COPIES + BLANKS)	PAGES
 Rainbow: picture cards	6–10
 Rainbow: second copies + blank cards	11–12
 Word-free cards (Rainbow) + photo-frame cards	13–18
CHARTS AND CHECKLISTS	PAGES
 Rainbow: 3 layouts, ready-made	19–21
 Rainbow: blank + fillable	22–23
Free bonus and what's next	24

Printer settings

Print at **100% / Actual size**, never "Fit to page", so cards stay 2.2 in (5.6 cm). White cardstock, 65–110 lb (176–300 gsm). Landscape pages turn by themselves in most printers; if not, choose "Auto-rotate".

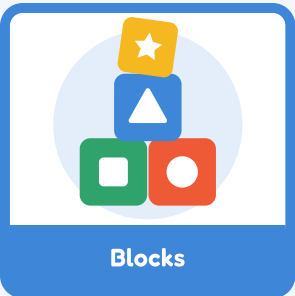
Your two files

This is the **Color file**. The Low-ink file has the same cards and charts in Simple: white cards, no tinted grounds. Both come in US Letter and A4.

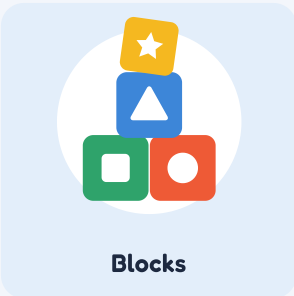
What you can type

Open this PDF in free **Adobe Acrobat Reader** (computer or phone). You can type labels on blank, word-free and photo cards, chart titles, names and big-kid jobs, and tick the checklist boxes. Colors and pictures can't be changed.

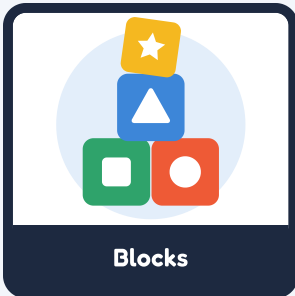
One card, four colorways



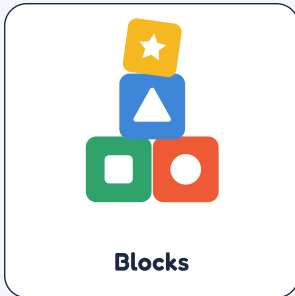
Rainbow
 Color file · Color-coded by routine



Soft
 Color file · Gentle tinted cards



Navy
 Color file · Bold navy frames



Simple
 Low-ink file · White cards, ink-saver

Make them last for years

1

Print on cardstock

White cardstock, 65–110 lb (176–300 gsm), at 100%. Let ink dry a few minutes.

2

Laminate the sheet

3–5 mil pouches. Laminate the full page, then cut. No laminator? Wide clear packing tape or a page protector works.

3

Cut with a sealed edge

Leave about 1/8 in (3 mm) of sealed plastic and round the corners so they're soft in little hands.

4

Dots, ages 3+

Rough (hook) dots on chart slots, **soft (loop)** dots on card backs. 3/4 in (19 mm) coin dots fit best.

5

Under 3: no dots

Lay cards on top of the chart, drop finished cards in the All done pocket, or slide the chart into a page protector and tuck cards in.

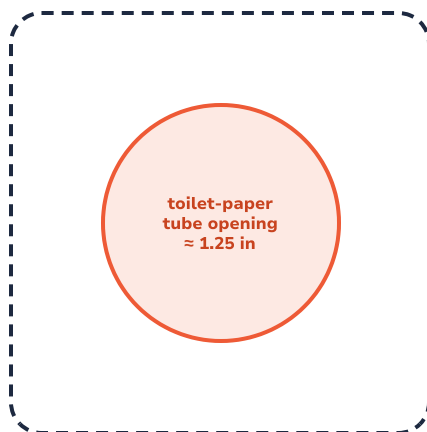
6

Store and reuse

Storage labels go on pouches or envelopes. Laminated blanks and checklists take dry-erase markers.

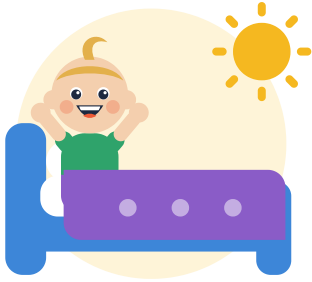
Safety for little hands

- **A grown-up stays close and keeps the pieces.** Routine cards are a together activity, not a toy to leave in the crib or bed.
- Every card is 2.2 in (5.6 cm) square, bigger than a toilet-paper tube opening, a common rule of thumb for small parts with children under 3. Don't shrink the cards when printing, and don't cut them into smaller pieces.
- Velcro dots, laminating scraps and loose plastic are small parts. **Check dots before each play; remove any that lift.** Keep spares out of reach, and skip magnets for any child who still puts things in their mouth.
- Hang charts low enough to reach without climbing, and away from blind cords. Every card follows our published safety rules.



Size check

Measure the dashed square with a ruler after printing. If it's **2.2 in (5.6 cm)** on each side, you printed at the right size and every card is bigger than a toilet-paper tube opening. If it's smaller, reprint at 100% / Actual size.

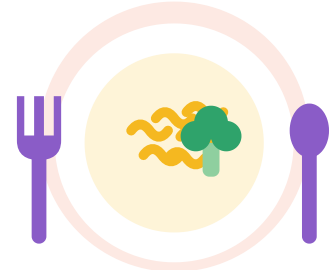
**Wake up****Potty****Wash face****Brush teeth****Get dressed****Shoes on****Coat on****Pack my bag****Hug goodbye****Car ride****Preschool****Wash hands**



Breakfast



Lunch



Dinner



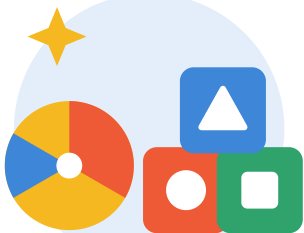
Snack



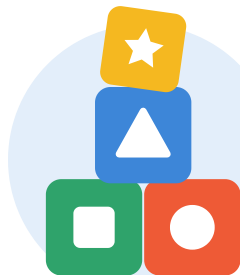
Drink water



All done eating



Play time



Blocks



Ball



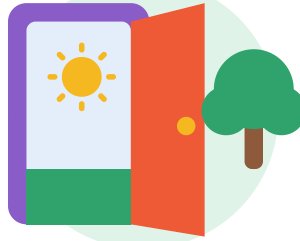
Puzzle

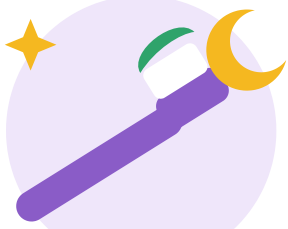


Pretend cooking



Drawing

**Music****Go outside****Park****Slide****Walk****Puddle jumping****Read together****Library****Bedtime story****Bath time****Towel dry****Pajamas**



Brush teeth



Lullaby



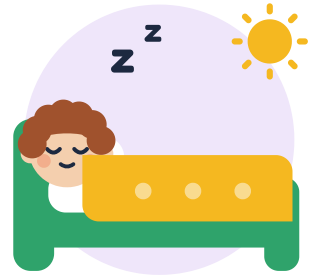
Cuddle



Lights off



Sleep



Nap



Tidy up toys



Feed the pet



Laundry basket



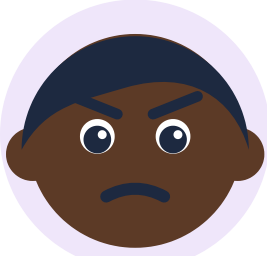
Set the table



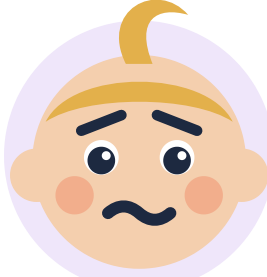
Happy



Sad



Mad



Worried



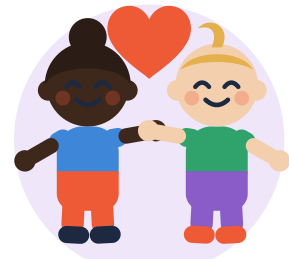
Tired



Calm



Big breath



Ask for a hug



First



Then



Wait



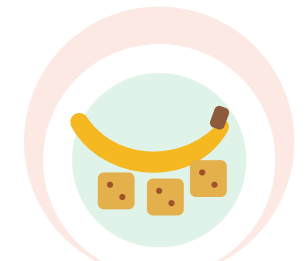
All done

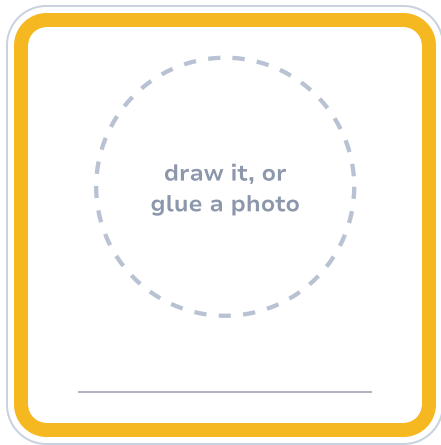
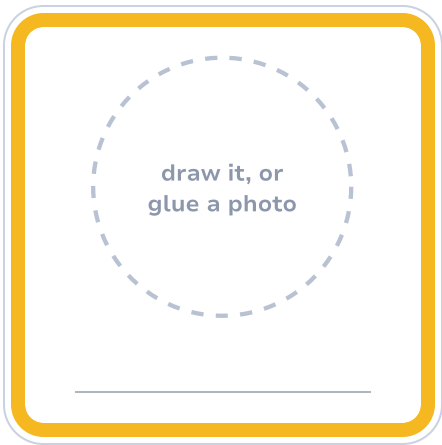
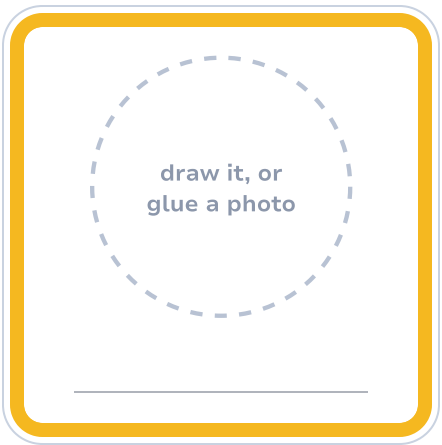
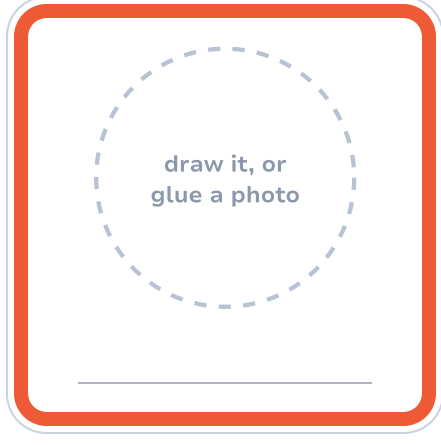
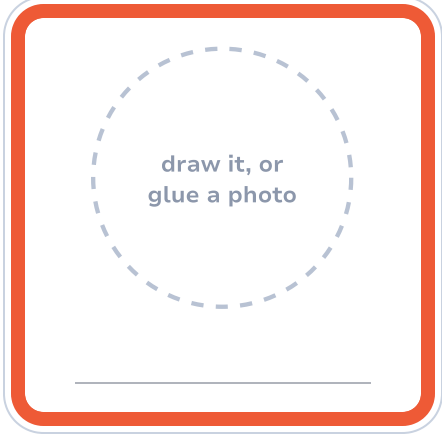
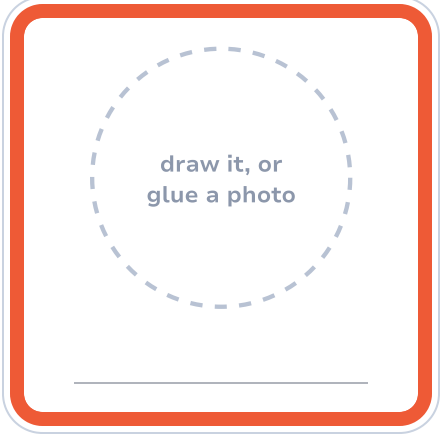
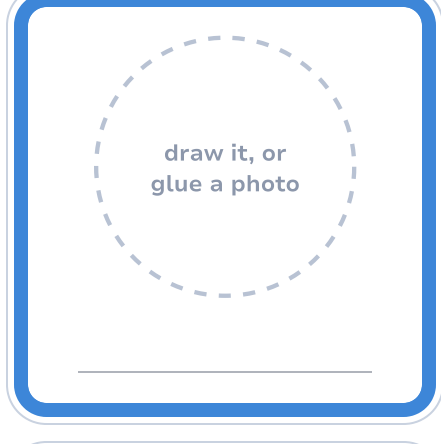
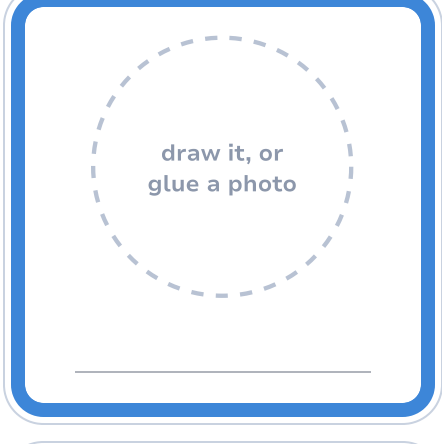
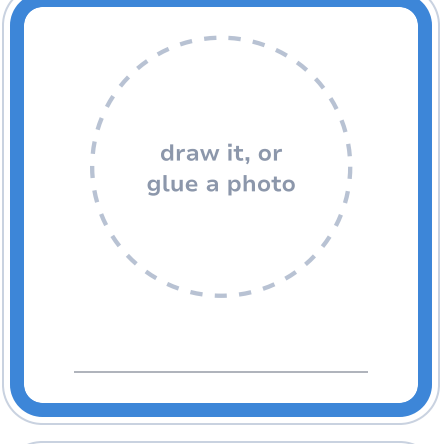
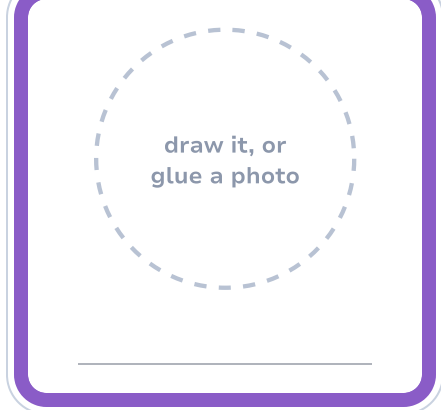
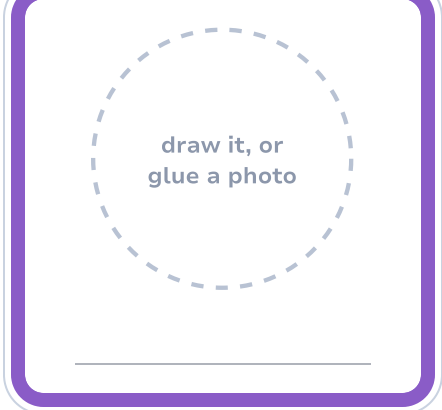
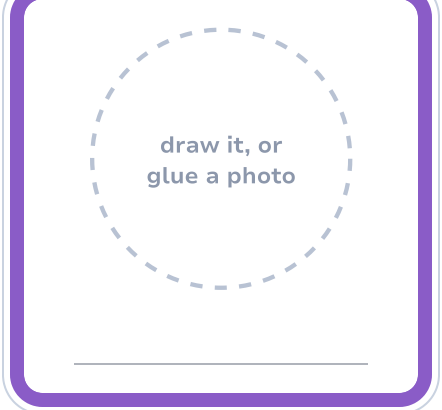


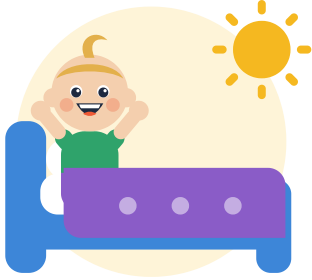
Play first

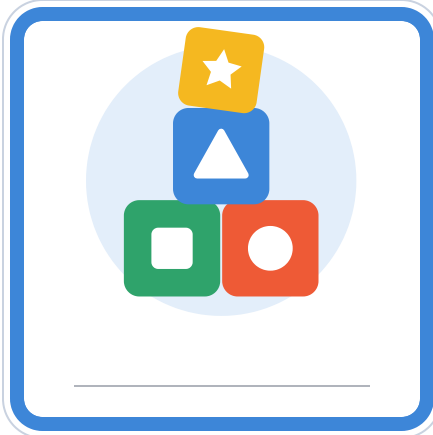
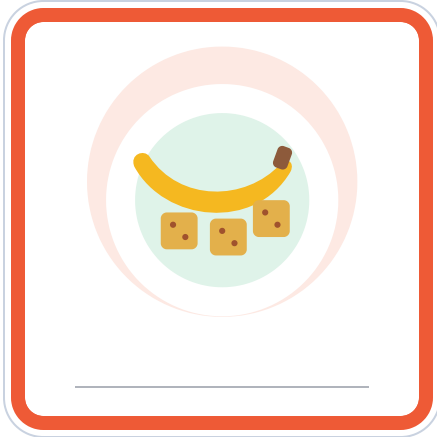
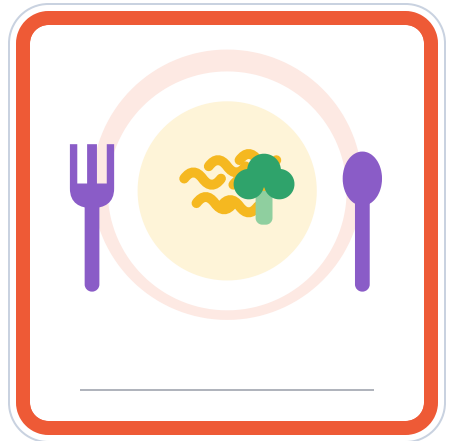
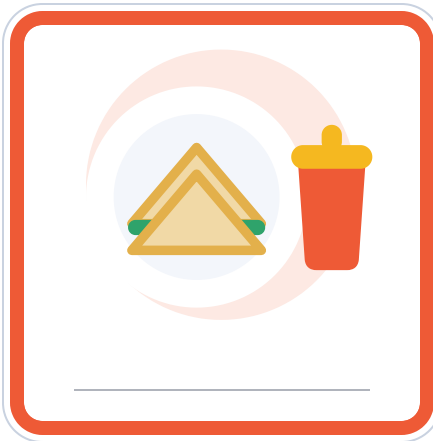


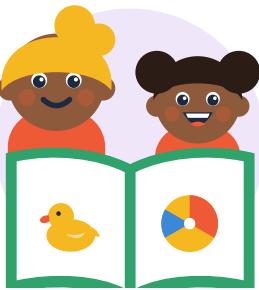
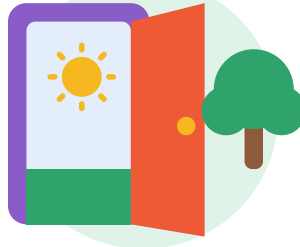
Screens later

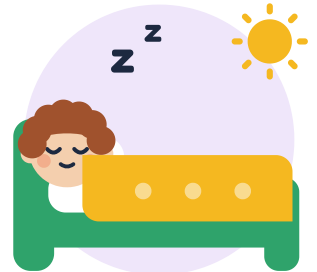
**Brush teeth****Brush teeth****Shoes on****Wash hands****Potty****Snack****Get dressed****All done****First****Then****Play first****Screens later**

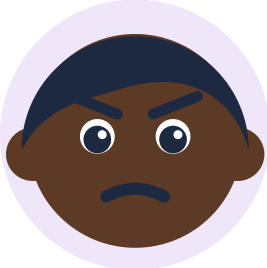
 draw it, or glue a photo	 draw it, or glue a photo	 draw it, or glue a photo
 draw it, or glue a photo	 draw it, or glue a photo	 draw it, or glue a photo
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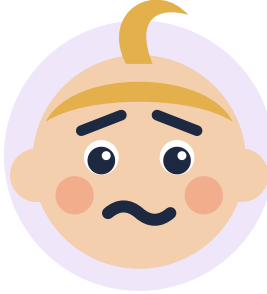








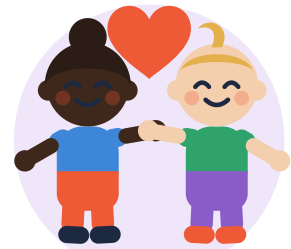












1













Photo cards

For the things only your family has: your front door, the car seat, grandma's house, the family pet.

- 1. Snap** a photo of the real thing, close up and in good light.
- 2. Print** it about 1.6×1.4 in (4×3.5 cm): a wallet-size photo print trimmed down works, or print the photo on plain paper at that size.
- 3. Glue** it inside the dashed frame with a glue stick and let it dry flat.
- 4. Label** by hand, or type in Acrobat Reader before printing this page. Then laminate and cut.

My steps

1

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

2

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

3

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

4

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

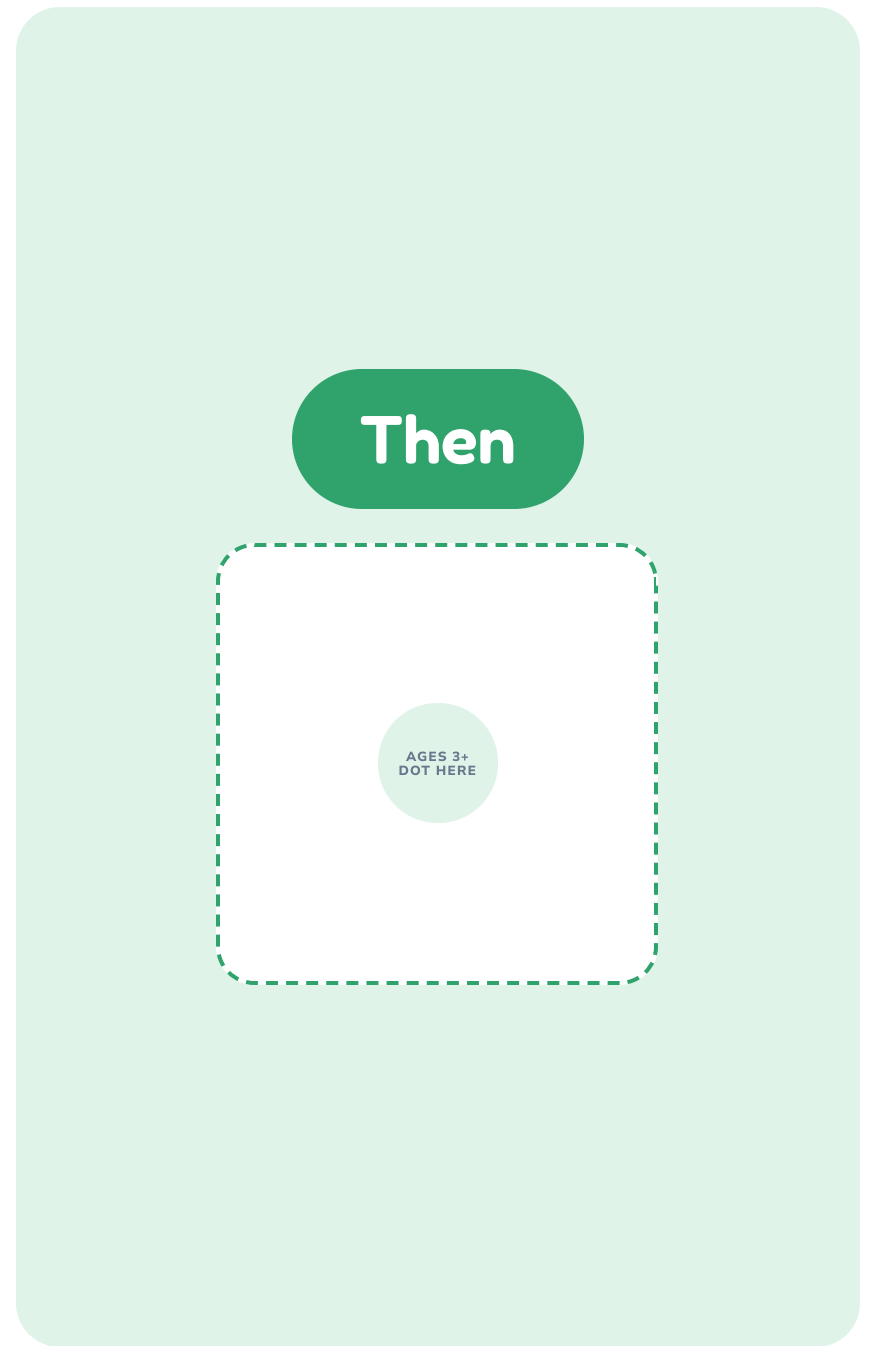
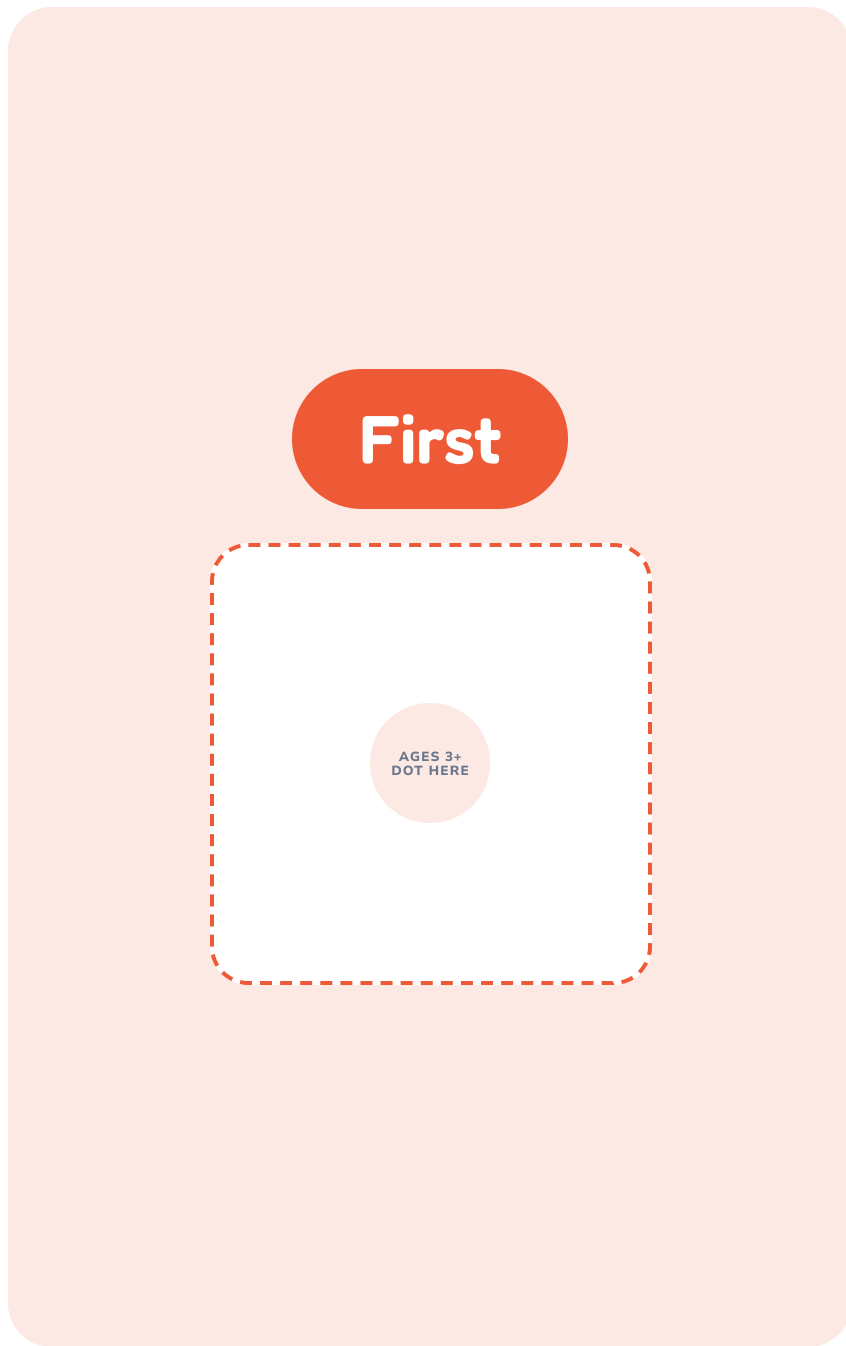
All done!

DONE
GOES HERE

DONE
GOES HERE

DONE
GOES HERE

DONE
GOES HERE



TALK TIP Offer a choice. Hold up two play cards for the "then" spot: "Blocks or bubbles?" A point is a real answer.



Name _____

ALL DONE When every card is done, we: *play blocks together!*

Play Before Pixels playbeforepixels.com
Version 1.0 · September 2026 · 21

1

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

2

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

3

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

4

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

DONE
GOES HERE

DONE
GOES HERE

DONE
GOES HERE

DONE
GOES HERE



My morning, one picture at a time

Name _____

1

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

2

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

3

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

4

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

5

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

6

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

7

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

8

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

9

AGES 3+
DOT HERE

ALL DONE When every card is done, we: _____

TALK TIP **Follow their lead.** Let your child pick the order of two steps. Their plan, their pride.

THANK YOU

Your free bonus is waiting

Scan the code for free seasonal routine cards (holidays, back to school, travel days) and short, practical play ideas for your child's age. We only ask for your email and, if you like, your child's birth month and year, never a name.



Scan, or type the short link

playbeforepixels.com/bonus/visual-routine-cards

Free companion download. Unsubscribe any time. Need your files again? Your download link stays in your order email; help is at playbeforepixels.com/help.

NEXT FOR YOUR FAMILY

The Complete Set

All 230 cards for ages 0–12, 6 chart layouts, 4 colorways and Monday or Sunday starts.

Play-First Family Kit

A play-first checklist, helping jobs, together tokens and a family play plan.

"I'm Bored" Play Cards

150 age-banded play ideas with a talk prompt on every card.



Which card did your child reach for first?

If you have a minute, an honest review helps other families decide. Tell them which card or chart your child went back to.

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